

How To Raise A Concern Or Complaint

First Things First

If something doesn't feel right, we'd rather know about it than not.

You do not need to have all the answers.

You do not need proof.

You do not need perfect wording.

If you're worried about something, tell us.

Is It A Complaint Or A Concern?

Complaint

A complaint is usually about:

- A service
- A decision
- An experience
- Communication
- Something you believe could have been handled better

Examples:

- A member of staff didn't respond.
- You feel you were treated unfairly.
- You're unhappy with a decision.

Concern

A concern is usually about:

- Safety
- Safeguarding
- Conduct
- Welfare
- Risk of harm
- Abuse or neglect
- Serious policy breaches

Examples:

- You believe someone is at risk.
- You have concerns about behaviour.
- You have witnessed something unsafe.

- You believe safeguarding action may be required.

How To Raise It

You can:

- Speak to a member of staff.
- Speak to a volunteer.
- Contact Veterans Backbone directly.
- Submit information in writing.
- Ask somebody to support you in raising the issue.

What Happens Next?

We will:

1. Listen.
2. Review the information provided.
3. Decide what action is needed.
4. Keep you informed where appropriate.
5. Take action proportionate to the issue raised.

Will I Get In Trouble?

No.

People raising genuine concerns or complaints in good faith will not be penalised for speaking up.

What If It Turns Out I Was Wrong?

That's okay.

We would rather investigate a concern that turns out to be nothing than ignore something important.

What If Somebody Is In Immediate Danger?

Call emergency services immediately if there is an urgent risk to life or safety.

Then notify Veterans Backbone as soon as possible.

Final Thought

Speaking up protects people.

Silence rarely solves problems.

If something doesn't feel right, tell somebody.